

Shri Hasan Mushrif,
Hon. Minister for Rural Development, Maharashtra



With the initiatives of the RD ministry the State Government has amended the Zilla Parishad and Panchayat Samiti Act 1961 to raise the number of representatives in Panchayat Samiti and Zilla Parishad; the number on ZP is increased to 2248 from 2000 and in PS it has grown up to 4496 from earlier 4000. The State Government has decided to distribute finance commission funds to Zilla Parishads and Panchayat Samitis also. Both local self-government bodies will get funds of 10 per cent each and 80 per cent will be allotted to Gram Panchayats effective from 2020-21. Earlier only Gram Panchayats would get all the funds.

Rewarding Corona Warriors

The State Government took a path-breaking decision during the Corona pandemic to provide insurance cover of Rs. 25 lakh to the employees of social organizations and institutes. Covid warriors who dared to help Corona patients were given incentives.

The RD ministry also implemented Veerbhadra Tararani Self-dependent Scheme to provide resources to earn livelihood for widow dependents of the Corona deceased. The widows will be absorbed in the self-help groups and they will be allotted interest-free loan of Rs. 350 per year to meet the criteria of PMJJBY and PMSBY. The widows who are engaged in food-processing were provided seed capital.

Epidemic Awareness

In order to make villages promptly responsive if an epidemics or pandemic on wider scale strikes, the RD ministry has announced formation of 5 teams, namely to undertake family health survey, to setup probable quarantine zones, to examine patients and shift them to hospitals, to provide vaccine and to work on helpline. This will promote health awareness in rural areas.

It is also decided that Gram Panchayat be awarded on the lines of smart village contest for taking initiatives in this regards. Therefore Gram Panchayat that had acted accordingly during the period of 1st June 2021 to 31st March 2022 will be awarded. The best three Gram Panchayat from each revenue region will be rewarded with Rs. 50 lakh, Rs. 25 lakh and Rs. 15 lakh. In all 18 Gram Panchayats will be rewarded from six revenue regions.

In addition these Gram Panchayat will also get development works sanction with their price money.Under DDUGKY the ministry has planned skill development initiatives for 50000 youths and help them get employment/self-employment in next year.



Shri Abdul Sattar,
Hon. MOS, Rural Development, Maharashtra

